

Which one-hour weeknight recipes deliver the most protein?

A reproducible comparison of a saved Recipe API snapshot

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1 Summary

This report asks a practical question for a busy home cook: among saved Recipe API results that require no more than 30 minutes of preparation, no more than 60 minutes total, and no more than 650 calories per serving, which options provide the most protein? The analysis begins with the same validated loading and recommendation behavior as the dashboard, then applies the report's explicit total-time ceiling.

The saved snapshot contains 54 unique recipes from six searches. 29 meet both decision limits. The highest-protein qualifying option is **Alabama White Sauce Chicken**, with 45 grams of protein, 450 calories per serving, 15 minutes of preparation, and 55 total minutes.

2 Evidence

Recipe	Search	Total time	Protein	Calories	Servings
Alabama White Sauce Chicken	chicken	55 min	45 g	450	6
Grilled Salmon	salmon	22 min	40 g	350	4
Grilled Salmon with Bearnaise Sauce	salmon	30 min	40 g	450	4
Astakos Me Makaronia (Lobster with Pasta)	pasta	35 min	40 g	550	4
Rachel Sandwich (Turkey Reuben)	turkey	15 min	35 g	550	1

Recipe	Search	Total time	Protein	Calories	Servings
Farfalle with Salmon	salmon	25 min	35 g	520	2
Alambre De Pollo (Chicken Alambre)	chicken	35 min	35 g	450	4
Almond Chicken	chicken	35 min	35 g	350	2

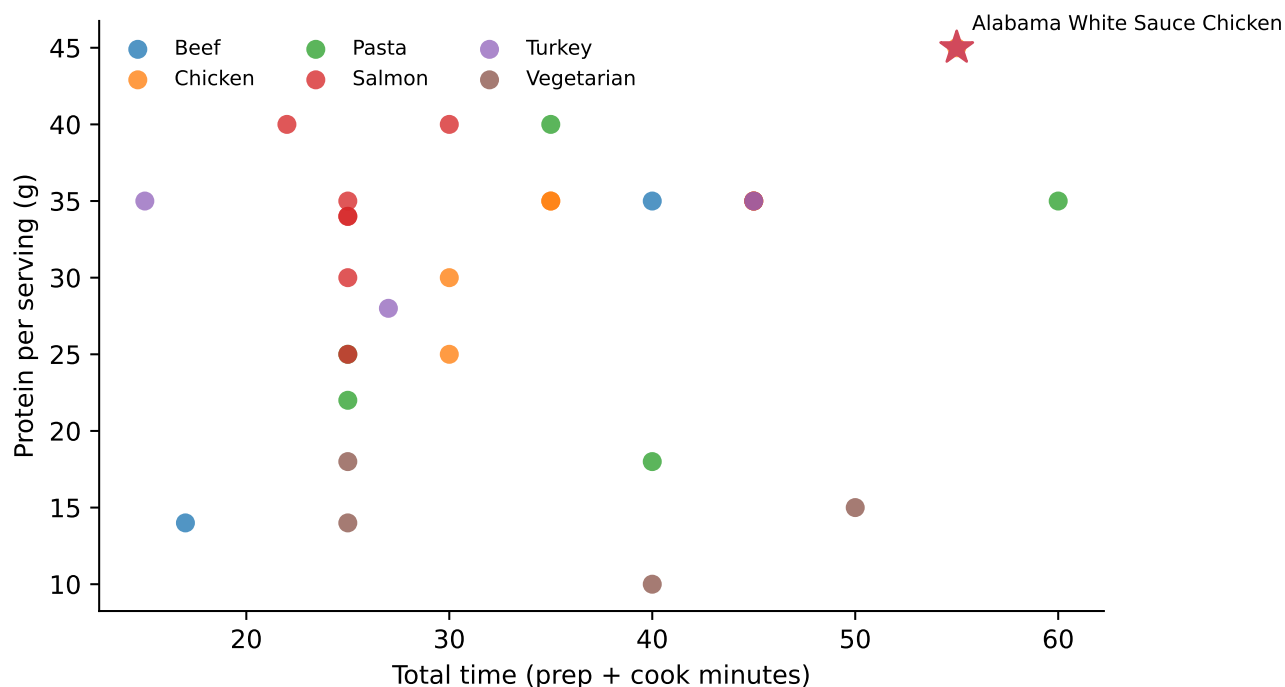


Figure 1: Protein and total time for recipes meeting the prep-time and calorie limits.

3 Interpretation

Protein adds a useful comparison beyond speed and calories. The one-hour ceiling prevents a recipe with brief hands-on preparation but several hours of cooking from being labeled a practical weeknight option. The top-ranked option answers this report’s specific question, but dietary tags, cuisine, serving count, and ingredient preferences may change a user’s final choice. Provider dietary tags should be treated as screening information rather than medical advice.

4 Reproducibility and provenance

- **Data source:** Recipe API (<https://recipeapi.io/>), retrieved on August 13, 2026.

- **Saved searches:** chicken, salmon, vegetarian, pasta, turkey, and beef; page 1, up to 10 results per search.
- **Evidence:** six committed raw JSON responses, six processed JSON summaries, and the derived `data/sample/weeknight-recipes.csv` snapshot.
- **Units:** preparation, cooking, and total time are minutes; calories and protein are reported by the provider per serving; protein is grams.
- **Analysis filters:** preparation time at most 30 minutes, total time at most 60 minutes, and calories at most 650 per serving. Qualifying recipes are then ordered by protein descending, total time ascending, and name.
- **Missing values:** recipes missing preparation time or calories are excluded by the shared recommendation function. Other missing provider measurements remain visible but are not invented.
- **Report render date:** 2026-08-13.

Rebuild the PDF from the repository root after `uv sync --locked` with `uv run python scripts/render_report.py`.